PROPFIRMS AS A BUSINESS

live 007

CFD prop firms, with Apex and Lucid as reference

Two kinds of prop firm

	CFD prop firm	Futures prop firm
Examples	FTMO, FundedNext	Apex, Lucid
You trade	A CFD at the firm's own price (US100)	A CME contract (NQ, MNQ)
Platforms	MT4, MT5, cTrader, TradingView	Rithmic, Tradovate
Size	Lots, with leverage	Contracts, with a contract cap
Costs	Spread, overnight swap, some commission	Commission per contract
Volume	Tick volume only	Real exchange volume
Rules set in	% of the account	Dollars
Fee	One-time	One-time, plus activation at Apex

Same Nasdaq, different instrument

$1 a point

1 lot of US100.cash. 20 lots = 1 NQ, 2 lots = 1 MNQ

1:50

leverage on indices (Standard). Swing: 1:15

$0

commission on US100 at FTMO. The spread is the cost

$4.59

swap per lot per night, long. $2.04 short

Tick volume

no exchange volume: VWAP and volume filters read differently

18:05 to 16:50

US100 trading hours, New York time

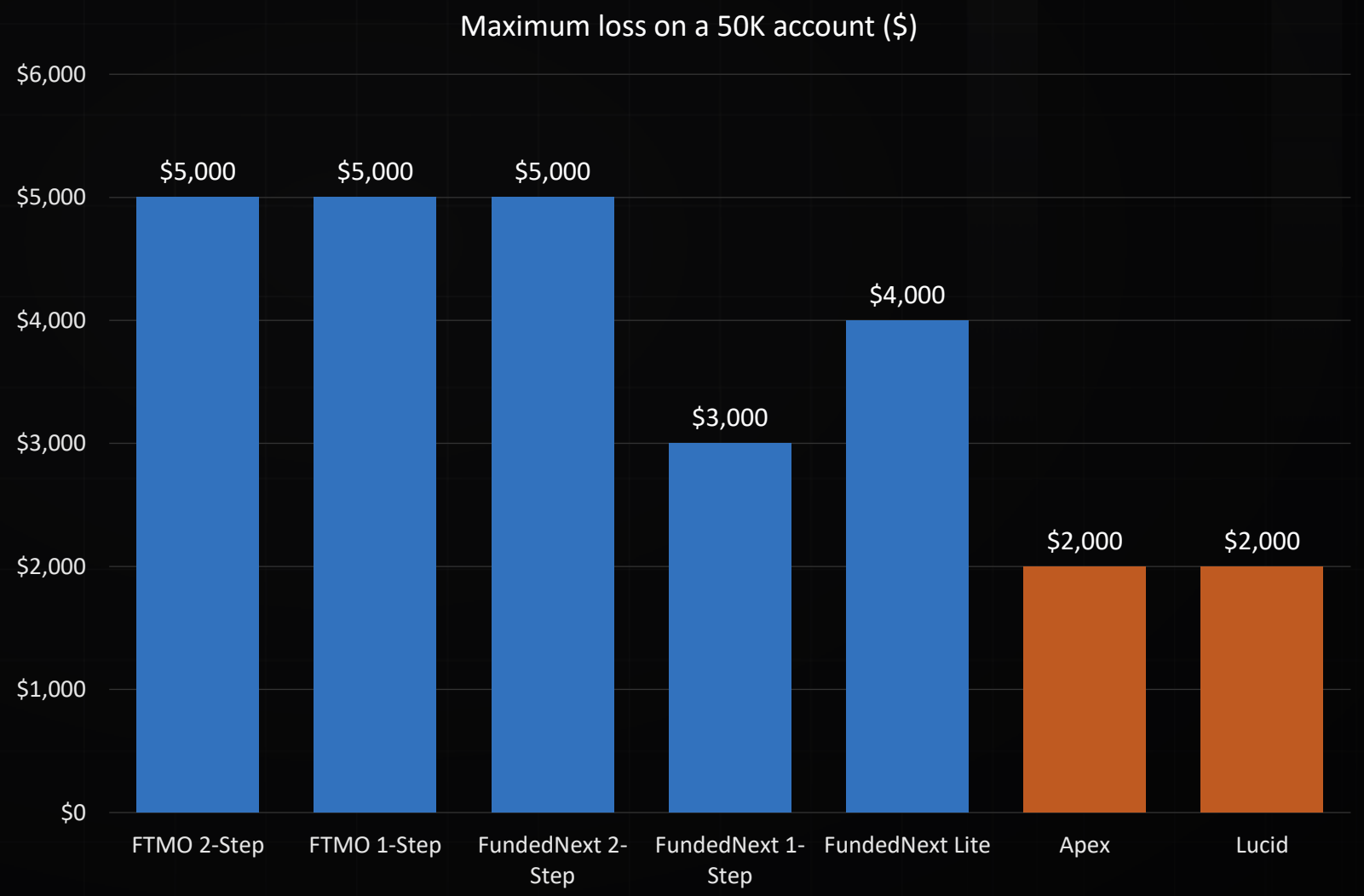
How much you may lose, at 50K

$5,000

FTMO 2-Step 50K. Fixed: the floor never moves

$2,000

Apex and Lucid 50K. Trails the best close



■ CFD ■ futures

FTMO

Rules in % of the account, the same at every size. One-time fee.

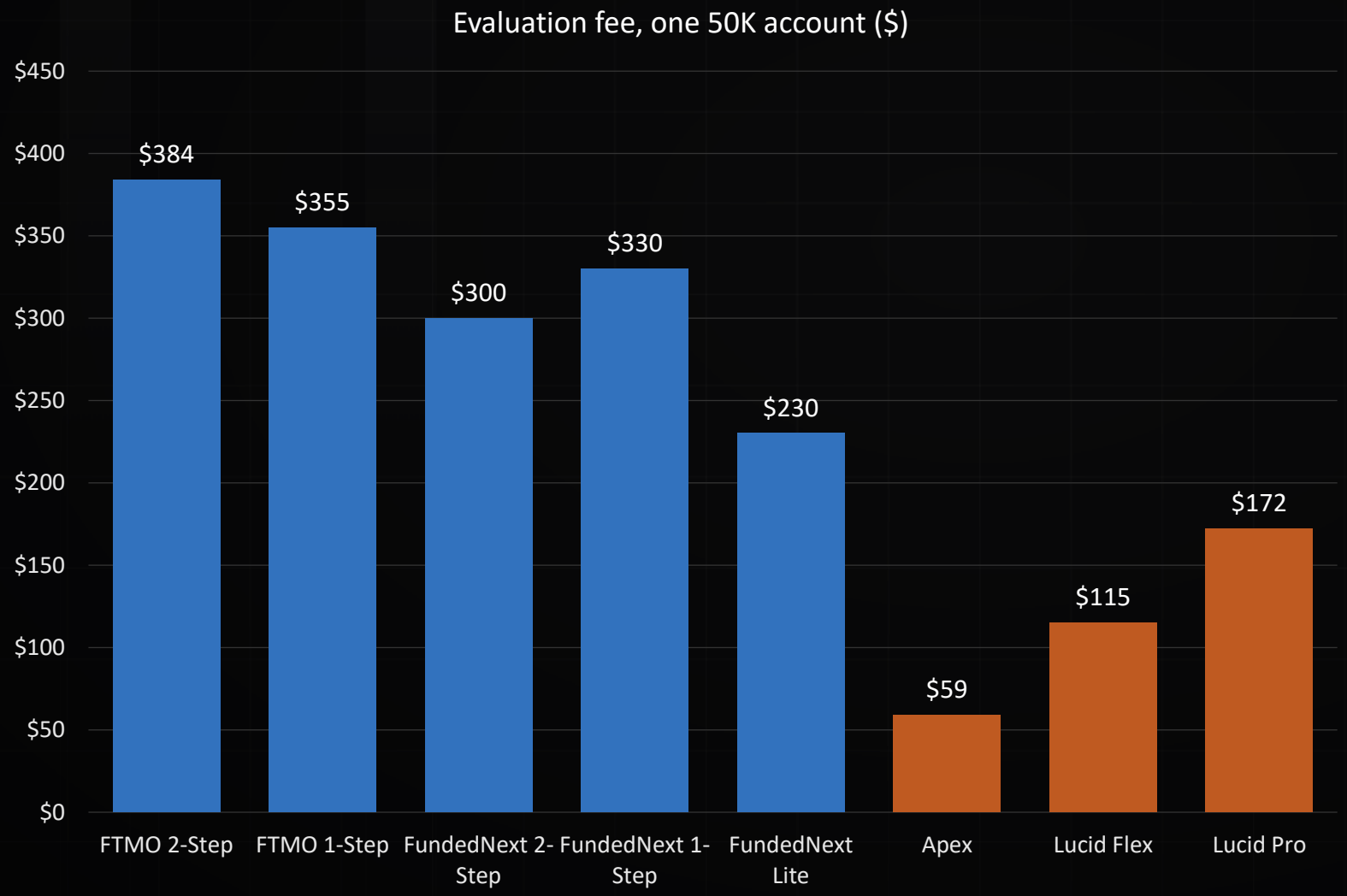
	FTMO 2-Step	FTMO 1-Step	FTMO Instant
Fee, 50K / 100K	€345 / €540	€319 / €499	€1,499 / €2,999
Profit target	10%, then 5%	10%	no evaluation
Daily loss	5%	3%	3%
Max loss	10%, fixed	10%, trails end of day	10%, trails intraday
Minimum trading days	4 per phase	none	none
Best day (funded)	no rule	max 50% of profit	max 30% of profit
Profit split	80%	90%	90%
Fee back	with the 1st reward	no	no

FundedNext

Rules in % of the account. One-time fee, add-ons cost extra.

	FundedNext 2-Step	FundedNext 1-Step	FundedNext Lite
Fee, 50K / 100K	$299.99 / $549.99	$329.99 / $569.99	$229.99 / $399.99
Profit target	8%, then 5%	10%	8%, then 4%
Daily loss	5%	3%	4%
Max loss	10%, fixed	6%, fixed	8%, fixed
Minimum trading days	5 per phase	2	2 per phase
Payouts	day 21, then every 14 days	every 5 business days	every 10 business days
Profit split	80%	80%	80%
Fee back	with the 1st reward	with the 3rd reward	with the 3rd reward

What one 50K account costs



Refund

FTMO 2-Step and FundedNext 2-Step pay the fee back with the first reward

No activation

FTMO, FundedNext and Lucid. Apex charges $119 once passed

Apex: $59 with coupon, $590 list.

Getting paid on CFD

	FTMO 2-Step	FTMO 1-Step	FundedNext 2-Step	FundedNext 1-Step
First payout	day 14	day 14	day 21	after 5 business days
Then	day 14 on each new account	day 14 on each new account	every 14 days	every 5 business days
Profit split	80% (90% scaled)	90%	80%	80%
Best-day rule	none	max 50%	none	none
Fee back	1st reward	no	1st reward	3rd reward
Cap per account	none published	none published	none published	none published

No payout ladder and no fixed number of payouts per account, unlike Apex and Lucid.

The platform gap, and our bridge

0 of 5

CFD prop platforms MultiCharts connects to today: MT4, MT5, cTrader, Match-Trader, TradingView

Where	Platform	How our strategies get there
Apex, Lucid	MultiCharts via Rithmic	directly, as today
FTMO, FundedNext	MetaTrader 5, cTrader	our bridge, in the works

MultiCharts stays. For the CFD platforms we are building a bridge, so the same strategies can trade there.

Rules that shape automated trading

	FTMO	FundedNext
Stop loss on every trade	not required	required on funded
Open risk	no limit in the rules	max 3% at any time
News	no orders ±2 min (Standard, funded)	only 40% of profit counts, ±5 min
Holding	overnight yes, weekend Swing only	overnight and weekend
Trades under 30 seconds	allowed	max 30% of profit
Daily limits	2,000 positions	200 trades

FundedNext sets more conditions per trade: a stop loss, 3% open risk, limits on short trades and news.

To run our algos on FTMO CFD

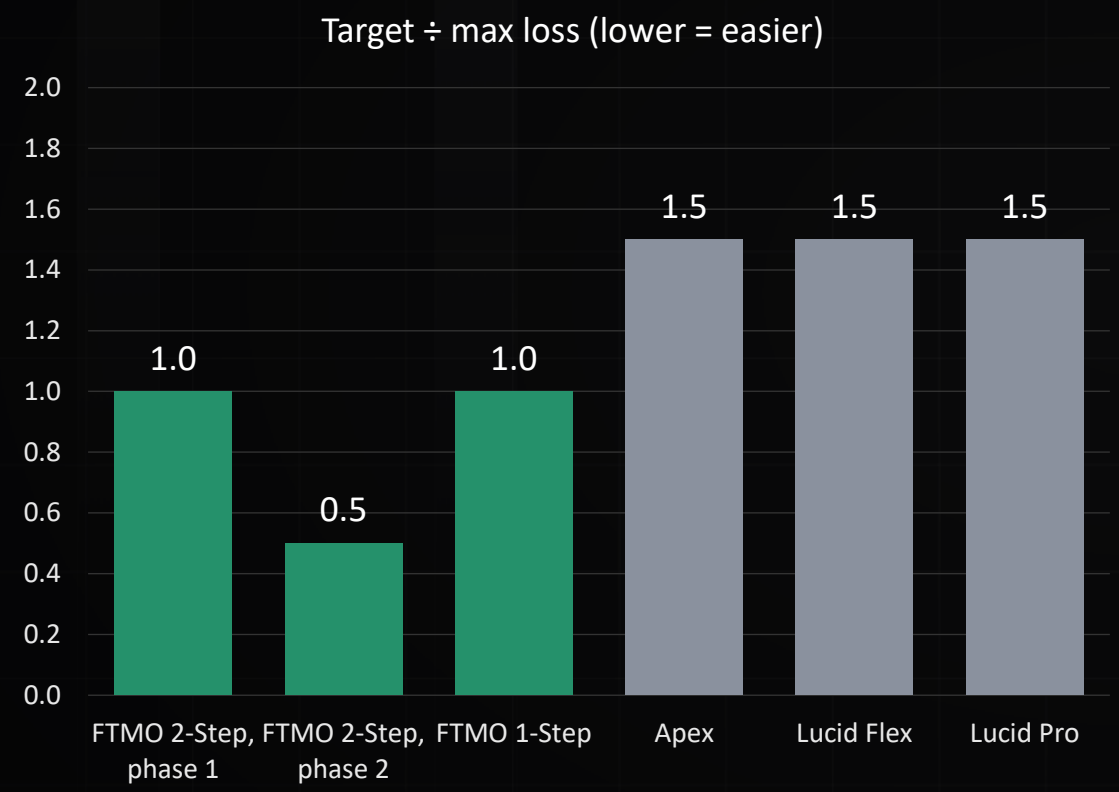
1. **Connect** MultiCharts to MT5 or cTrader through our bridge (in the works)
2. **Re-test** on FTMO's US100 data: cash index, tick volume. VWAP and volume filters change
3. **Size in lots** $1 a point per lot: 20 lots = 1 NQ, 2 lots = 1 MNQ
4. **Costs** spread on every trade, swap $4.59 per lot per night long
5. **Clock** FTMO's day and daily loss reset run on Prague time (server GMT+2)
6. **Account type** Swing to hold over weekends. Standard: no orders ±2 min around news

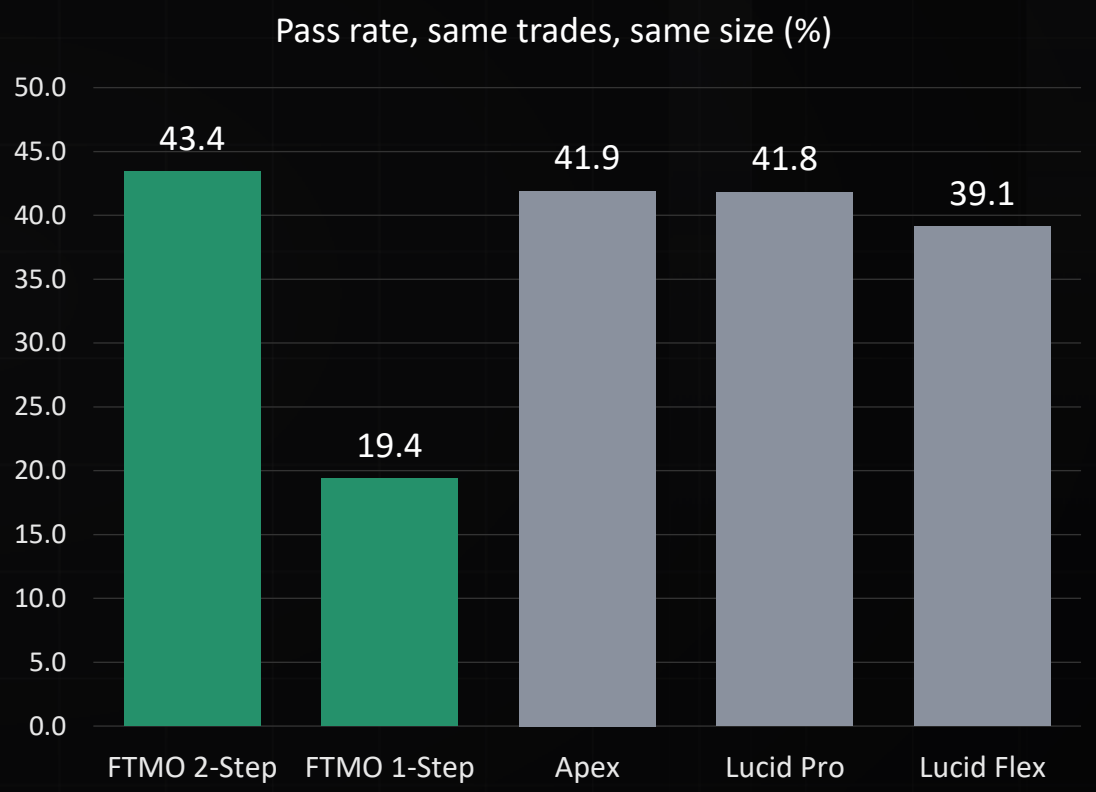
FTMO against Apex and Lucid, at 50K

	FTMO 2-Step	FTMO 1-Step	Apex	Lucid Flex	Lucid Pro
Fee	€345	€319	$59 with coupon	$115	$172
Activation fee	none	none	$119	none	none
Profit target	$5,000, then $2,500	$5,000	$3,000	$3,000	$3,000
Max loss	$5,000, fixed	$5,000, trails	$2,000, trails	$2,000, trails	$2,000, trails
Daily loss	$2,500, ends account	$1,500, ends account	$1,000, ends day	$1,200 or off	$1,200 or off
Best-day rule	none	50%	none	40% or 50%	none
Time limit	none	none	30 days	none	none
Phases	2	1	1	1	1

FTMO gives more room and a bigger target. Apex and Lucid stop the day, FTMO stops the account.

Easier to pass





Same trades, same size: FTMO 2-Step passes most often, 1-Step least. Its $1,500 daily loss ends the account.

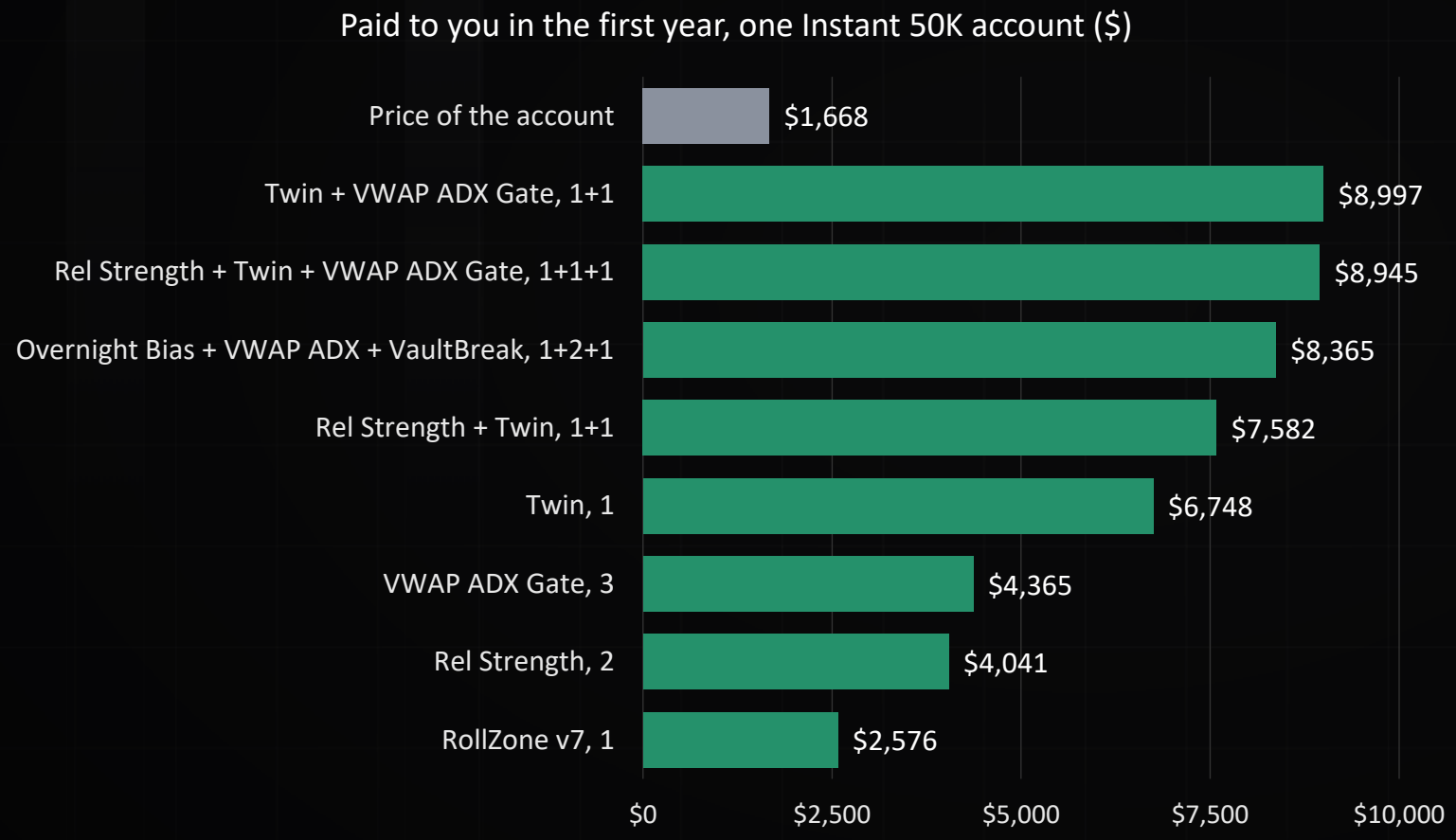
Left: profit target divided by max loss at 50K, from the published rules. FTMO 2-Step 10% target (5% in phase 2) on a 10% max loss, FTMO 1-Step 10% on 10%, Apex and Lucid $3,000 on $2,000. It leaves out daily loss limits, phases and the instrument.
Right: four NQ strategies on one 50K account at 2+2+6+2 MNQ, out-of-sample days (25 Aug 2025 to 24 Sep 2026), 20,000 simulated evaluations each, only the rules swapped. Apex and Lucid: Funded Lab, 7 Oct 2026. FTMO: 12 Nov 2026, same method. Pass rate = share that reach the target (2-Step: both phases). No costs; NQ trades, not US100.

Easier to get paid

	FTMO 2-Step	FTMO 1-Step	Apex	Lucid Flex	Lucid Pro
First payout	day 14, any profit	day 14, any profit	5 days of $250+, $2,600 profit	5 days of $150+	$500 cycle goal
Best-day rule	none	50%	50%	none	40%
Per request	your share of all profit	your share of all profit	ladder, $1,500 first	50% of profit, max $2,000	$2,000, then $2,500
Your share	80%	90%	100%	90%	90%
Most one account pays	no cap published	no cap published	$13,000, then closes	$9,000, then live	$10,800, then live
Accounts	$400K in total	$400K in total	20 funded	5 funded	5 funded
Fee back	1st reward	no	no	no	no

FTMO pays any profit from day 14, no ladder. Apex pays 100%, but only above $52,100 and in a $13,000 ladder.

FTMO Instant: what you pay, what it pays



$1,668

the price (€1,499). No evaluation, one account at a time

5.4x

Twin + VWAP ADX Gate at 1+1 MNQ paid its price back, 3.2% blown

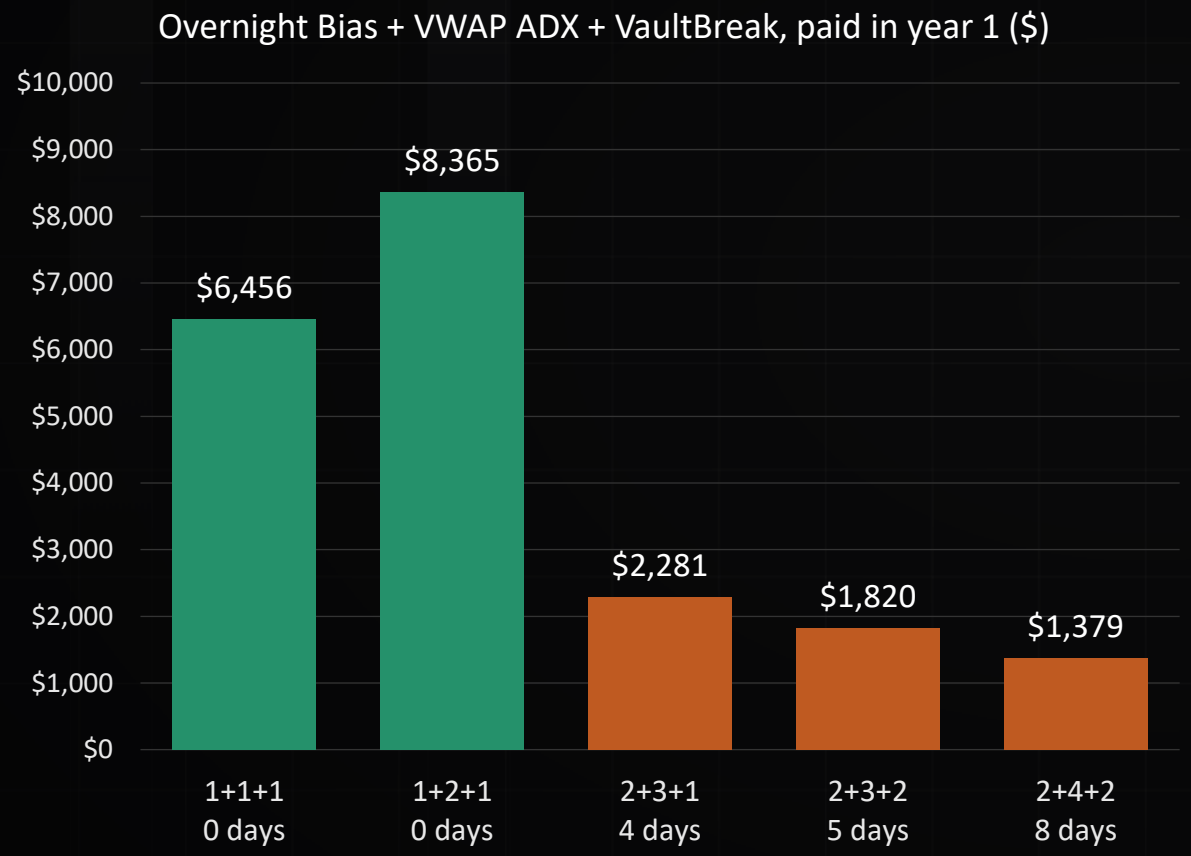
-$1,500

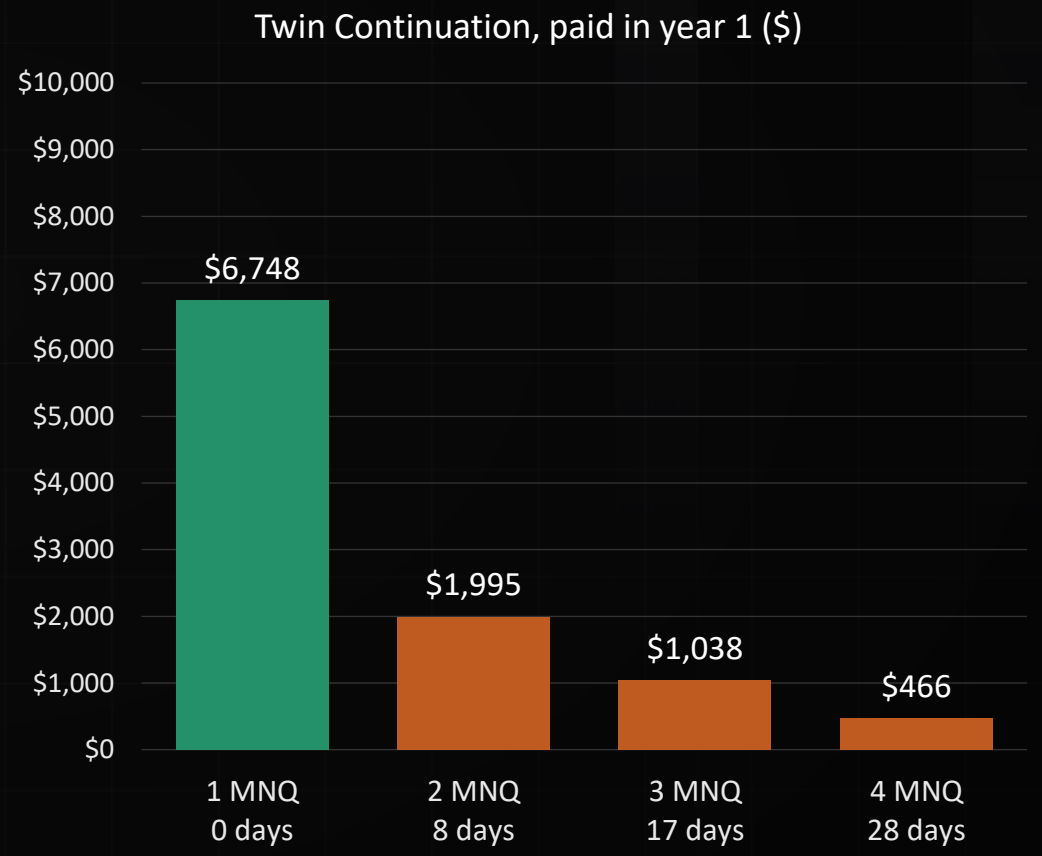
one day this far down ends it, so each set is sized by its worst day

Every set paid back its price. Apex, same Twin + VWAP ADX Gate: $252 per funded account, $4,243 in year 1.

Simulated, out of sample, 20,000 accounts each, NQ trades, costs $1.70 per MNQ. Sized by the worst backtest day; $2,000 kept above the max loss after each payout.

Why one size more blows it up

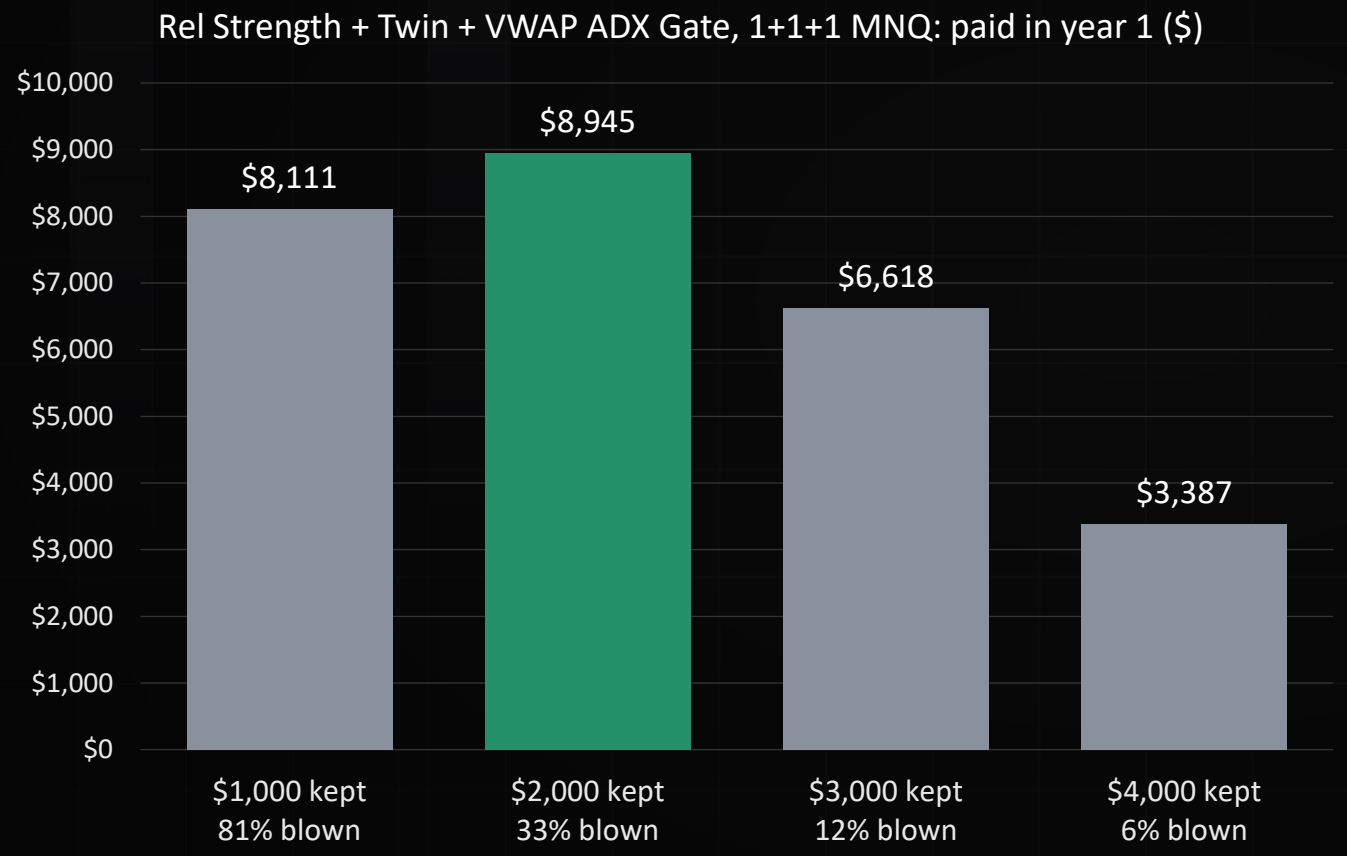




One day down $1,500 ends an FTMO account. Size by your worst day, not your average day.

Paid to you in the first year, out of sample, 20,000 accounts per size, costs in. Under each bar: test days whose worst point reached -$1,500 at that size (284 test days for the left set, 482 for Twin). Green: none. Twin has had trades run $7,500 to $12,000 per NQ against it.

Why Instant accounts end: the payout eats the room



$5,000

the most room an Instant account ever has. Its max loss rises with each new high and stays put after a payout

No help

from a buffer first: waiting for $5,000 of profit, still 32% blown, first payout day 69 instead of 51

No stop

the max loss keeps trailing, also after payouts. Apex's stops at +$100, FTMO's never does

Keep about $2,000 above the max loss after every payout. A buffer before the first payout adds nothing.

Out of sample 26 Dec 2024 to 29 Oct 2026, 20,000 accounts each, costs in. Kept = left above the max loss after each payout. Blown = ended within the year, mostly after paying out.

Rel Strength + Twin + VWAP ADX Gate, on all five

MNQ	FTMO 2-Step	FTMO 1-Step	Apex	Lucid Pro	Lucid Flex
1+1+1	99.3%, 106 days	98.5%, 66 days	17.9%, 16 days	74.5%, 31 days	74.6%, 32 days
1+2+2	84.7%, 63 days	35.5%, 29 days	36.2%, 14 days	59.2%, 18 days	58.3%, 20 days
2+2+2	73.4%, 46 days	37.5%, 22 days	36.9%, 10 days	43.3%, 11 days	40.4%, 14 days
2+3+6 (Apex's pick)	36.3%, 24 days	21.6%, 12 days	34.4%, 7 days	38.1%, 7 days	32.5%, 11 days

$8,945

FTMO Instant at 1+1+1: paid in year 1 for $1,668, 33% blown

$7,473

Apex funded at 1+1+2: paid in year 1 for $291 per funded account, up to 20 accounts

Bigger sizes pass faster (FTMO 2-Step: 106 days at 1+1+1, 24 at 2+3+6), but the tail decides. FTMO has no emergency stop: Apex and Lucid end the day at the daily limit, FTMO ends the account.

Pass rate, median trading days to pass. Out of sample 26 Dec 2024 to 29 Oct 2026, 20,000 runs per cell, costs $1.70 per MNQ. Green: highest in the row. Our own exports, not the research strategies of the Easier to pass slide.

Where our algos run

	Apex	Lucid	FTMO (CFD)
Connection	MultiCharts via Rithmic	MultiCharts via Rithmic	our bridge, in the works
Instrument	NQ, MNQ	NQ, MNQ	US100 CFD
Holding	flat by 4:59 PM ET	flat by 4:45 PM ET	overnight yes, weekend Swing only
Funded accounts	20	5	$400K in total
What it takes	nothing new	nothing new	the bridge, then a re-test on US100

Apex and Lucid run our strategies today. FTMO follows with the bridge and a re-test on US100.

Verdict

Easiest to pass, on the rules and the odds

FTMO 2-Step

43.4% with the same trades and size (Apex 41.9%, Lucid Pro 41.8%). Catch: 2 phases, a $2,500 day ends it. 1-Step: 19.4%

Paid on the least profit

FTMO

any profit from day 14, no ladder. Apex needs $2,600 first

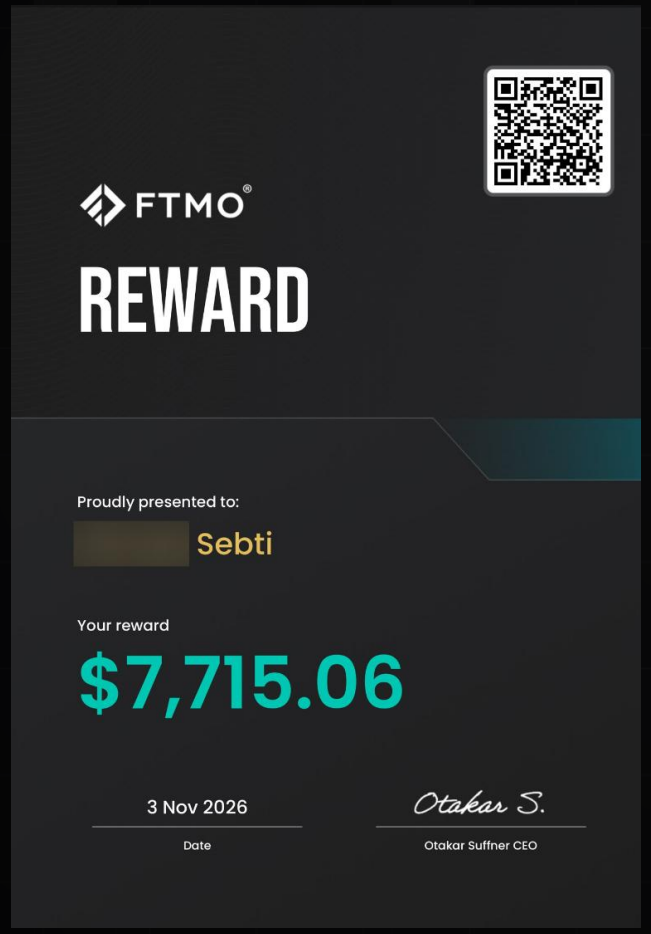
Most accounts

Apex

20 accounts at $13,000 each, 100% split

Pass rates: four NQ strategies at the same size (2+2+6+2 MNQ), out-of-sample days, 20,000 simulated evaluations per account, no costs.

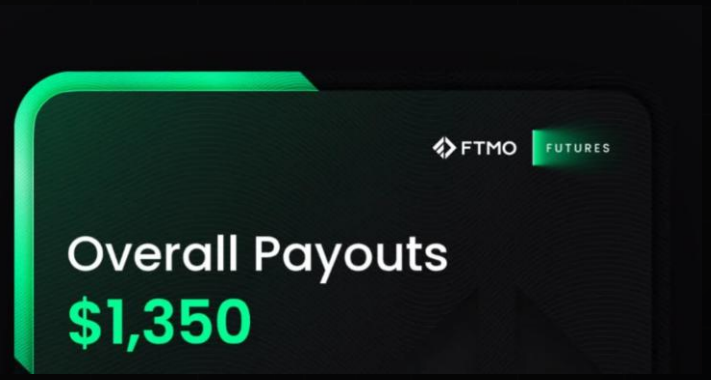
Passed and paid



Sebti
FTMO Reward $7,715.06 · 3 Nov 2026



Leonardo
FTMO 1-Step · 11 Nov 2026



FTMO Futures
Overall payouts $1,350

Fine print

Published rules and list prices, except Apex at its coupon price ($59, list $590). Checked: FTMO and FundedNext CFD 23 Oct, Apex 3 Oct (price 12 Nov), Lucid 3 Nov 2026.

Rules apply to accounts bought today. Older accounts can still run on older rules.

FTMO CFD fees are in euros, converted at the ECB rate of 11 Nov 2026: 1 EUR = 1.1127 USD.

Simulations: Apex and Lucid pass rates from the Funded Lab (7 Oct 2026); FTMO pass rates and the FTMO Instant value on 12 Nov 2026 with the Funded Lab's method and FTMO's rules. Pass rates: same NQ trades for every firm, out-of-sample days 25 Aug 2025 to 24 Sep 2026, no costs. FTMO Instant and its Apex comparison: costs of $1.70 per MNQ. Our strategies are not tested on US100 CFD yet.

Sources

https://www.ecb.europa.eu/stats/policy_and_exchange_rates/euro_reference_exchange_rates/html/eurofxref-graph-usd.en.html

Apex 50K Rithmic EOD Trail product page: $590 for one month, coupon as low as $59; 5-pack $2,450, as low as $245 (12 Nov 2026)

https://ftmo.com/en/symbols/

ftmo.com and help.fundednext.com rule pages (checked 23 Oct 2026)

https://apextraderfunding.com/help-center/ (EOD evaluation, EOD payouts, scaling; checked 3 Oct 2026)

https://support.lucidtrading.com and lucidtrading.com plans (checked 3 Nov 2026)

https://www.multicharts.com/brokers/

Funded Lab in The Bridge, rules swapped one at a time on the same trades (7 Oct 2026)

FTMO simulation, 12 Nov 2026: the Funded Lab evaluation loop (reproduces its 7 Oct Apex and Lucid rates exactly) with FTMO 50K rules; same 20 research exports, out-of-sample days 25 Aug 2025 to 24 Sep 2026, 20,000 runs per account; no costs

FTMO Instant simulation, 12 Nov 2026 (CFD Propfirms, sim folder): research exports (out of sample 25 Aug 2025 to 24 Sep 2026) and our MultiCharts exports (25 Dec 2024 to 2 Nov 2026); each set at the largest size whose worst in-sample day stayed above -$1,500; $2,000 kept above the max loss after each payout; 20,000 accounts; costs $1.70 per MNQ

Funded Lab, 12 Nov 2026 (run read-only): Apex 50K EOD, sizes picked on the in-sample days by the lab, out of sample, 20,000 accounts, costs $1.70 per MNQ; evaluation $59 coupon + $119 activation

Rel Strength + Twin Continuation + VWAP ADX Gate, our MultiCharts exports, 12 Nov 2026 (CFD Propfirms, sim folder): out of sample 26 Dec 2024 to 29 Oct 2026, 20,000 runs, costs $1.70 per MNQ; evaluations with the Funded Lab loop (Apex, Lucid) and its FTMO version; Apex funded from the Funded Lab (read-only)